

POL-IT-002 - Data Retention and Disposal Policy

Policy | IT

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Related Scenario ID		Document Type	Policy

1. Purpose

This policy defines how long each category of platform information is retained, when it is disposed of, and how disposal is performed and evidenced.

It exists to balance two conflicting requirements: operational and legal needs to retain records, and the obligation not to retain information beyond its purpose.

2. Scope

Applies to all platform information: seller records, customer records, transaction records, tickets, incidents, transcripts, runbooks, policies, access logs and diagnostic artefacts.

Applies to primary storage, backups, archives and analytical extracts.

3. Definitions

Term	Definition
Active period	Period during which a record is in routine operational use
Archive period	Period after the active period during which a record is retained but not routinely accessed
Disposal	Destruction or irreversible de-identification
Legal hold	Suspension of disposal for records relevant to a legal matter
De-identification	Removal or transformation of identifying fields so the record is no longer personal data

4. Retention Schedule

Record category	Active	Archive	Total	Basis
Seller commercial agreements	Life of account	7 years	7 years post-closure	Contract and tax
Seller account documents	Life of account	3 years	3 years post-closure	Commercial reference
Settlement and payout records	3 years	5 years	8 years	Financial and tax
Tax invoices and credit notes	3 years	5 years	8 years	Tax obligation

Record category	Active	Archive	Total	Basis
Refund and chargeback records	2 years	3 years	5 years	Financial
Support tickets	2 years	1 year	3 years	Operational reference
Call transcripts	1 year	1 year	2 years	Operational reference
Engineering incident reports	3 years	2 years	5 years	Reliability analysis
Operation runbooks and procedures	Current version plus 2 prior	2 years	Superseded at +2 years	Operational
Policies	Current plus superseded	7 years	7 years from supersession	Governance
Security incident records	3 years	4 years	7 years	Security and legal
Access and authentication logs	12 months	6 months	18 months	Security investigation
Diagnostic artefacts	Investigation duration	None	Deleted at closure	Temporary by nature
Analytical extracts	Defined per extract	None	Expiry on the extract	Purpose limitation

R-1. Where two categories apply to a record, the longer retention period applies.

R-2. A record that is the subject of a legal hold is retained until the hold is lifted, regardless of the schedule above.

5. Disposal Rules

R-3. Disposal is performed through an approved mechanism that removes the record from primary storage, backups and archives within one backup cycle.

R-4. Deleting a record from an application is not disposal where a backup retains it. The backup schedule governs the completion date.

R-5. Disposal is evidenced. Each disposal run produces a record of the categories processed, the counts, the date and the operator.

R-6. De-identification is acceptable in place of destruction where the residual record has analytical value and all identifying fields are irreversibly transformed.

R-7. Disposal must be performed such that the record cannot be recovered from the medium.

6. Diagnostic Artefacts

R-8. Diagnostic artefacts are temporary. They are deleted immediately after the investigation or incident that produced them concludes.

R-9. This includes temporary scripts, log extracts, query outputs, exported spreadsheets and intermediate files.

R-10. Where a diagnostic artefact has ongoing value, it is converted into a documented runbook or procedure and retained under that category, not retained as an artefact.

This rule applies to dataset generation and analysis work as well: scripts and intermediate files produced while creating a deliverable are deleted once the deliverable is complete and verified, leaving only the deliverable.

7. Analytical Extracts

R-11. An extract created for a defined purpose carries an explicit expiry date on creation.

R-12. An extract must not be retained beyond its expiry, even where it remains useful.

R-13. An extract spanning multiple sellers must be created under the Data Access Policy's scoped extract rules, including where the requester has organization-wide access, where the extract is used for a purpose narrower than that access.

8. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
IT (Platform Administrator)	Policy ownership, disposal execution, evidence
Record owners	Correct category assignment at creation
Engineering	Automated disposal for system-generated records
Data owners	Expiry management for extracts they author
All identities	Delete diagnostic artefacts after use

9. Exceptions

E-1. Retention may be extended beyond the schedule where a documented business, legal or regulatory reason exists, with Platform Administrator approval and a defined end date.

E-2. Retention may be shortened where a record is personal data with no continuing purpose. Shortening requires the same approval.

E-3. No exception may waive R-4 (backup disposal) or R-8 (diagnostic artefact deletion).

10. Escalation

Situation	Escalate to	Timeframe
Legal hold required	Platform Administrator and Business	Immediately
Disposal blocked by a system limitation	Engineering	5 working days
Records found beyond their retention period	IT, investigate scope	5 working days
Extract past expiry in use	Data owner and IT	Immediately
Diagnostic artefact containing credentials found	IT, as a security incident	Immediately

11. Enforcement

System-generated records carry a category field that drives automated disposal. A record created without a category is rejected.

Retention duration is reported monthly by category. Categories exceeding their schedule are escalated.

Extract expiry is enforced by the data platform; an expired extract is no longer accessible even where the underlying data remains retained.

12. Review History

Version	Date	Change	Owner
1.0	2023-02-27	Initial retention policy	IT
2.0	2025-06-16	Category-based schedule; legal hold formalised	IT
2.1	2026-03-02	Diagnostic artefact and analytical extract rules added	Admin

Next scheduled review: March 2027.